# Minrui Gong 龚敏瑞

Postdoctoral Researcher
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## Research Fields

Corporate finance, M&A; labor markets, human capital; innovation, patents

## Academic Positions

2026 – present Postdoctoral Researcher (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter), Chair of Corporate Finance (Prof. Ernst Maug), University of Mannheim

2020 – 2026 Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter), Chair of Corporate Finance, University of Mannheim

2020 – 2022 Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter), Institute for Employment Research (IAB), Nuremberg.
Funded by the DFG project "Corporate Finance and Human Capital Risk" (project no. 280387323)

## Education

2020 – 2026 **PhD (Dr. rer. pol.) in Finance**, University of Mannheim
Center for Doctoral Studies in Business (CDSB). *Summa cum laude*.
Dissertation: "The Dynamics of Intangible Capital: Transaction, Reallocation, and Production"
Advisors: Prof. Ernst Maug, PhD; Prof. Dr. Oliver Spalt

2018 – 2020 **M.Sc., Mannheim Master in Business Research**, University of Mannheim
Overall grade 1.4 ("very good"; German scale, 1.0 = best). PhD-level coursework in finance, econometrics and microeconomics.
Thesis: "German Business Groups and Their Internal Factor Markets" (grade 1.0)

2014 – 2018 **Bachelor of Economics in Finance** (bilingual programme), Southwestern University of Finance and Economics (SWUFE), Chengdu
Average score 88.71/100.
Exchange semester: Frankfurt School of Finance & Management, spring 2017

## References

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## Job Market Paper

**Judged by the Company You Acquire** Latest version: minruigong.com/jmp.pdf

An acquirer's decision to undertake an acquisition, together with its choice of target, depends on and can hence reveal its technological gap. The underlying selection mechanism allows the market to distinguish technological laggards from leaders and update valuations accordingly. I measure this revealed gap as the technological overlap between the target and the acquirer's industry. Acquirers with larger revealed gaps experience more negative announcement returns, but only when the target is more transparent than the acquirer and thus conveys information beyond the market's prior beliefs. This effect is concentrated in the component of target choice unexplained by acquisition determinants identified in prior studies. Moreover, revealed gaps induce opposite market reactions among the acquirer's industry peers. Additional tests help rule out alternative explanations. Taken together, these findings highlight a selection-based mechanism that helps explain the cross-section of acquirer announcement returns.

## Working Papers

**Arbitraging Labor Markets** (with Ernst Maug and Christoph Schneider)
ECGI Working Paper Series in Finance No. 997. SSRN

We develop a new rationale for firms to operate in multiple locations within the same country. We show that business group firms relocate operations and grow less if firms of the same group in other local labor markets offer a better labor supply, an improved fit between the requirements of the firm and the local labor force, and lower labor costs. The first two aspects are more important than costs; hence, business groups primarily address their access to human capital. Relocation is concentrated in industries with lower asset tangibility, in high-skilled jobs, and in business groups with decentralized managerial functions. Local labor conditions are of similar importance to and distinct from agglomeration economies. Business groups predominantly move jobs, but not employees, between their locations. As such, they arbitrage local labor markets.

**Tolerance for Failure: Evidence from Patent Examination** (with Bastian Koch)

We introduce a novel firm-level measure of failure tolerance based on firms' patenting histories. Specifically, we quantify failure tolerance as the largest scope loss during patent examination that does not terminate a firm's innovation sequence. Firms with greater failure tolerance tend to produce patents that are more valuable, more cited, more complex, yet also more likely to fail. At the same time, they file fewer patents and employ fewer inventors, resulting in an ambiguous relationship between failure tolerance and total innovation output. Exploiting inventor job switches, we provide causal evidence that higher failure tolerance enhances inventor productivity.

## Work in Progress

**Are Labor Market Reforms Still National?** (with Ernst Maug)
Do employment protection reforms in one OECD country spill over, through multinational firms, to the same firms' affiliates in other countries? Orbis ownership data linked to LinkUp job postings.

## Grants

2026 – 2027 COBRA Research Grant, Mannheim Center for Corporate Behavior and Regulation Analysis, EUR 10,000
For "Are Labor Market Reforms Still National?"

## Presentations

* presented by a co-author

*Judged by the Company You Acquire*

2026 FMA Annual Meeting (Tampa); German Finance Association (Düsseldorf); GEABA Symposium (Mainz); Aarhus Finance Forum; FMA European Conference (Braga)

2025 EUROFIDAI-ESSEC Paris December Finance Meeting; ERC Summer School and PhD Workshop (Paris); BCFM PhD Conference (Frankfurt)

*Arbitraging Labor Markets*

Scheduled Workshop on Labor Markets and Financial Markets (Nuremberg, December 2026)

2026 American Finance Association* (Philadelphia); University of Bath*; University of Exeter*

2025 European Finance Association (Paris); Western Finance Association (Snowbird); Edinburgh Corporate Finance Conference*; SGF Conference* (Zurich); Central European University*; University of the Balearic Islands*; Free University Berlin*; University of Duisburg-Essen*; University of Washington*

2024 CSEF-RCFS Conference on Finance, Labor and Inequality (Capri); EFMA Annual Meeting (Lisbon); GEABA Symposium (Bonn); German Finance Association* (Aachen); Paris December Finance Meeting*; University of Bristol*; University of British Columbia*; University of Münster

*Tolerance for Failure*

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| Scheduled | Southern Finance Association (Palm Springs, November 2026); American Economic Association* (Washington, DC, January 2027) |
| 2026 | FMA Annual Meeting* (Tampa); German Finance Association* (Düsseldorf); GEABA Symposium* (Mainz); Benelux Corporate Finance Days* (Ghent); World Finance Conference* (Limerick); Labor and Finance Group Spring Conference* (Nashville); BCFM PhD Conference* (Cologne) |

## Discussions

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| 2026 | German Finance Association (Düsseldorf); FMA European Conference (Braga) |
| 2025 | NEFI PhD Research Workshop; BCFM PhD Conference (Frankfurt) |
| 2024 | EFMA Annual Meeting (Lisbon) |

## Teaching

University of Mannheim, all courses taught in English

*As lecturer*

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| Spring 2027 | Corporate Finance and Employees (MSc), about 60 students (scheduled) |
| Fall 2026 | Corporate Finance I – Case Study (MSc), about 40 students |

*As teaching assistant (for Prof. Ernst Maug)*

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| 2020 – 2025 | Corporate Finance I – Case Study (MSc), about 80 students per year.<br>Tutorials on building valuation models in Excel; grading. |
| 2022 – 2026 | Corporate Finance and Employees (MSc; until 2024 BSc course "Corporate Finance and Human Capital"), about 60 students per year.<br>Helped develop the course; tutorials on event studies and difference-in-differences; designed and graded the group assignment and final exam. |
| 2021 – 2026 | Corporate Finance II (MSc), about 60 students per year. Grading. |

*Supervision*

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| 2021 – present | 17 master's theses (16 valuation case studies, 1 empirical) |

## Skills

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| Data | Orbis; IAB administrative employment data; USPTO / PatentsView; LinkUp job postings; WRDS (SDC, CRSP, Compustat, Capital IQ, I/B/E/S) |
| Methods | Event studies; difference-in-differences (staggered, continuous treatment); instrumental variables; high-dimensional fixed effects; text analysis with large language models and transformer models |
| Computing | Stata, Python, SQL (DuckDB), high-performance computing (bwUniCluster), LaTeX, Excel valuation modelling |
| Visualization | Data visualization and slide design with professional graphics software (Adobe Illustrator) |
| Languages | Chinese (native), English (C1), German (B2) |